“build the wall” on the U.S.-Mexico border are echoes of deep-seated white supremacist fantasies in the United States that have countered freedom principles throughout the nation’s history. Berlin continues as a point of reckoning and return, once again, to measure those principles against our own practices of repression, to grapple with the weight of history and dreams of transcendence.

In the spirit of critical reflection, *A Wall of Our Own* attempts to gather the many disparate accounts of American artists beckoned to divided Berlin into a shared historical frame. This book also is meant to serve as a roadmap of creative process, moving in and out of divided Berlin, through other geopolitical sites of division, toward critical engagement and awakening. The path follows a critical and curious stance to life along our borders.